DELHI'S ELECTRIC REVOLUTION

THE POLICY THAT IS REIMAGINING INDIA'S CAPITAL



Rekha Gupta
Chief Minister, Delhi

As India celebrates another year of independence, Delhi has quietly scripted one of the most transformative environmental and mobility reforms. In the history of Delhi's battle against pollution, few decisions will be remembered as transformative as the Delhi Electric Vehicles Policy 2026. The launch marks far more than the introduction of another government scheme. It represents a future-ready vision to reclaim clean air whilst reducing dependence on fossil fuels and placing its citizens at the center of a sustainable transportation revolution.

In a city where vehicular emissions have long remained one of the major contributors to air pollution, the Government of NCT of Delhi (GNCTD) has chosen decisive action over incremental change. The Delhi EV Policy 2026 is not merely incentivizing electric vehicles; it is fundamentally reshaping how mobility will evolve in India's capital over the coming decade. Notified with effect from July 1, 2026, the policy has been designed to accelerate electric mobility across all major vehicle categories, improve air quality and create a comprehensive electric mobility ecosystem for the capital. The policy recognises clean air as a public right and places environmental protection and energy conservation at the heart of transport planning.

This is not a policy for a niche segment. It is a policy for every resident of Delhi- from the student commuting to college, to the delivery entrepreneur, the auto-rickshaw driver, the small trader, the fleet operator and the middle-class family purchasing its first vehicle.

A Policy Born from Necessity

The policy was conceived against a stark reality. Studies and reports presented before various authorities have consistently highlighted vehicular emissions as a major contributor to Delhi's air pollution burden. Two-wheelers constitute nearly two-thirds of Delhi's vehicle population, while three-wheelers and commercial goods vehicles clock significantly higher daily mileage than private cars. Recognizing that transportation reform is indispensable to improving air quality, the Government undertook an ambitious exercise to create a policy framework capable of delivering large-scale environmental benefits while remaining economically viable and socially inclusive, thereby making vehicle electrification a public health intervention rather than merely a technological choice.

The result is a comprehensive four-year policy framework that seeks to accelerate EV adoption across major vehicle categories, establish an extensive charging ecosystem and reduce dependence on ICE vehicles. Yet what truly distinguishes the Delhi EV Policy 2026 is its willingness to move beyond incentives and embrace transformational change.

The Courage to Lead

Every major policy breakthrough requires political courage. Delhi's EV Policy 2026 exemplifies this political resolve by charting India's first clear, time-bound roadmap for the mandatory electrification of key vehicle segments. Under the policy, from 1 January 2027, only electric three-wheelers and N1 category (upto 3.5 tonne GVW) goods carriers will be eligible for new registrations in Delhi. Building on this momentum, from 1 April 2028, all new two-wheelers registered in the Capital will be electric, marking a decisive shift towards a cleaner and future-ready transport ecosystem.

These measures are revolutionary because they move the conversation beyond voluntary adoption. They create certainty for manufacturers, investors, charging operators, fleet owners and consumers alike. By providing a clear transition timeline, the policy sends a powerful signal that the future of mobility in Delhi is electric. Such bold mandates are expected to influence policy discussions across India, much like Delhi's earlier environmental initiatives became templates for national reforms.

Designed for Every Citizen

One of the most remarkable aspects of the policy is its inclusiveness. Unlike policies that primarily benefit affluent consumers, Delhi's EV Policy 2026 has been carefully structured to cover virtually every segment of society.

For middle-class families and daily commuters, electric two-wheelers are supported through purchase incentives linked to battery capacity during the first three years of implementation.

For auto-rickshaw drivers, the backbone of last-mile connectivity in Delhi, the policy provides substantial purchase incentives for electric autos (e-3W).

For small businesses, logistics operators, e-commerce delivery fleets, electric N1 goods carriers receive dedicated incentives, helping commercial operators transition away from polluting vehicles.

For families replacing old vehicles (i.e. BS-IV and below), the policy introduces attractive scrapping incentives that reward citizens for retiring older, more polluting vehicles and replacing them with EVs. Scrapping incentives are available across multiple vehicle categories, including two-wheelers, three-wheelers, passenger cars, goods carriers and Grameen Sewa vehicles.

The message is clear: the clean mobility transition should not be restricted to a privileged few. Every Delhi resident should have the opportunity to participate and benefit.

